

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

-----X
HOPETON SUAREZ,

Plaintiff,

- against -

THE CITY OF NEW YORK and JAMES M. GRANT,

Defendants.
-----X

Index No.

Plaintiff designates
Kings County as
place of trial.

The basis of the
venue is the
location of occurrence.

S U M M O N S

Plaintiff resides at:
210 Parkside Avenue (2F)
Brooklyn, New York 11220

County of Kings

To the above named defendant(s):

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's attorney within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgement will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: New York, New York
December 10, 2018

SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C.
Attorneys for Plaintiff
HOPETON SUAREZ
Office & P.O. Address
30 Vesey Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007
(212) 227-8865

The City of New York, 100 Church Street, New York, N.Y. 10007
JAMES M. GRANT, c/o 70th Precinct, Brooklyn, New York

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

-----X
HOPETON SUAREZ ,

Index No.

Plaintiff,

- against -

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

THE CITY OF NEW YORK and JAMES M. GRANT,

Defendants.

-----X

Plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ** , complaining of the
defendants, by his attorneys, SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C., hereby
sets forth and alleges, upon information and belief, as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on
October 5, 2017, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ** , was and still is
a resident of the County of Kings, City and State of New York.

2. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on
October 5, 2017, the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**,
(hereinafter referred to as "**THE CITY**") was and still is a
domestic municipal corporation, duly organized and existing under
and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

3. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on
October 5, 2017, the defendant, **JAMES M. GRANT**, (hereinafter
referred to as "**GRANT**"), was and still is a resident of the City
and State of New York.

4. That, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, has complied

with all the conditions precedent to the commencement of the within action against the defendant, **THE CITY**; plaintiff's Notice of Claim was served on December 28, 2017, within ninety (90) days of the date that the within cause of action having been caused to accrue; that thirty (30) days have elapsed and the claim remains unpaid and unadjusted; that, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, testified at an oral examination pursuant to the General Municipal Law on October 25, 2018; and, that this action is being commenced herewith within one (1) year and ninety (90) days of the date that the within cause of action having been caused to accrue.

5. That, on October 5, 2017, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was operating a motor vehicle on Linden Boulevard and Flatbush Avenue, in the County of Kings, City and State of New York.

6. That, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was driving from Coney Island.

7. That, there were no passengers in the motor vehicle being operated by the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**.

8. That, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, had parked his motor vehicle at the aforementioned location in a legal and permitted spot.

9. That, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, thereafter saw various police officers, and/or other agents, servants, and/or employees of the defendant and/or defendants, approach his motor vehicle without lights or sirens.

10. That the aforementioned police officers, agents, servants, and/or employees of the defendant and/or defendants had ordered that the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, step out of his motor vehicle.

11. That, without probable cause and without reasonable cause, the motor vehicle being operated by the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was searched.

12. That, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was never advised as to why the aforementioned motor vehicle was searched, nor if there were any charges being filed against him.

13. That, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was taken by the aforementioned police officers, and/or other agents, servants, and/or employees of the defendant and/or defendants, to the 70TH Precinct, where he was placed in a holding cell.

14. That, while in the holding cell, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was processed, and interrogated by various police officers, and/or other agents, servants, and employees of the defendant and/or defendants, without probable cause, without reasonable course and without justification.

15. That, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was thereafter taken to Central Booking, by the aforementioned police officers, and/or other agents, servants, and/or employees of the defendant and/or defendants.

16. The plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was seen by a judge.

17. The plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was injured as

a result of the foregoing.

18. The plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, appeared in court on various occasions as a result of the above.

19. All charges against the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, were thereafter adjourned in contemplation of dismissal.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

20. That, on October 5, 2017, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was assaulted/battered by the defendant, and/or defendants by and through their agents, servants and/or employees.

21. That, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was assaulted/battered without justification and without cause and without excuse.

22. That, the assault/battery took place on Linden Boulevard and Flatbush Avenue, in the County of Kings, City and State of New York, and other locations wherein the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ** was held against his will by the defendant and/or defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees.

23. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned and on October 5, 2017, and for sometime prior thereto, defendant, **GRANT**, was a New York City police officer, and/or agent servant and/or employee of the City, working in the scope and course of his employment as a New York City Police Officer, and was employed by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

24. That, the aforementioned assault and battery of the

plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was carried out by police officers and/or other servants, agents and/or employees of the defendant, and/or defendants, while working within the scope and course of the employment with the defendant **THE CITY**.

25. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was injured; was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled; was and/or will be caused to undergo medical treatment and advice; was unable to pursue his usual and regular activities; and, upon information and belief, his injuries are permanent in nature and effect.

26. That this action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

27. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

28. That, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, repeats, reiterates, and realleges, each and every allegation as set forth in paragraphs 1 through 27 with the same force and effect as if

hereinafter more fully set forth at length herein.

29. That, all of the aforementioned acts, committed by police officers, servants, and/or other employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**, were committed due to the negligence, recklessness and carelessness of the aforementioned police officers, agents, servants and/or other employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**.

30. That the defendant, **THE CITY**, was additionally negligent, reckless and careless in the negligent hiring, negligent retention, and negligent training of various police officers, agents, servants and/or other employees, who were employed by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

31. That, all of the aforementioned acts, committed by the police officers, agents, servants and/or other employees of the defendant, **GRANT** were committed due to the negligence, recklessness and carelessness of the aforementioned police officers, agents, servants and/or other employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**.

32. That, the defendant, **THE CITY**, was additionally negligent, reckless and careless in the negligent hiring, negligent retention, and negligent training of various police officers, agents, servants, and/or other employees, including, but not limited to defendant, **GRANT**, who was employed by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

33. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff,

HOPETON SUAREZ, was injured; was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled; was and/or will be caused to undergo medical treatment and advice; was unable to pursue her usual and regular activities; and, upon information and belief, his injuries are permanent in nature and effect.

34. That this action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving the defendant and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

35. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, HOPETON SUAREZ has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

36. That the plaintiff, HOPETON SUAREZ , repeats, reiterates, and realleges, each and every allegation as set forth in paragraphs 1 through 35 with the same force and effect as if hereinafter more fully set forth at length herein.

37. That, on October 5, 2017, the plaintiff, HOPETON SUAREZ, was caused to be arrested without probable cause.

38. That, the plaintiff, HOPETON SUAREZ, was detained/arrested without an arrest warrant, nor any type of warrant and/or warrants.

39. That, the false arrest/false imprisonment took

place on Linden Blvd. and Flatbush Avenue, in the County of Kings, City and State of New York, and other locations and wherein the plaintiff, HOPETON SUAREZ, was held against his will by the defendant and/or defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees.

40. That, the aforementioned false arrest/false imprisonment of the plaintiff, HOPETON SUAREZ, was carried out by police officers and/or other servants, agents and/or employees of the defendant, THE CITY.

41. That, the aforementioned false arrest/false imprisonment of the plaintiff, HOPETON SUAREZ, was carried out by defendant, GRANT, and/or other servants, agents and/or employees of the defendant, THE CITY, while working within the scope and course of the employment with the defendant THE CITY.

42. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, HOPETON SUAREZ, was injured; was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled; was and/or will be caused to undergo medical treatment and advice; was unable to pursue his usual and regular activities; and, upon information and belief, his injuries are permanent in nature and effect.

43. That this action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions as well as the defendant and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

44. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

45. The plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, repeats, reiterates, and realleges, each and every allegation as set forth in paragraphs 1 through 44, with the same force and effect as if hereinafter more fully set forth at length herein.

46. That the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ** did not commit any illegal act, nor did the individually named defendant, **GRANT**, have reason to believe he committed an unlawful act, either before or at the time he was falsely detained/imprisoned, assaulted and battered, excessive force was used against him; and deprived of his constitutional rights pursuant to the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments as set forth in the Constitution of the United States, particularly 42 U.S.C. §1983 and the Constitution of the State of New York.

47. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, **GRANT**, was employed in his respective capacity by the defendant, **THE CITY** and was acting under the color of his official capacity and his acts were performed under the color of the policies, statutes, ordinances, rules and regulations of the defendant, **THE CITY**.

48. Defendant, **GRANT**, is being sued in his personal

and official capacities for violation of plaintiff's constitutional rights pursuant to 42 USC, §1983. Although defendant, **GRANT** knew or should have known of the fact that this pattern of conduct was carried out by their agents, servants and/or employees, the defendant, **THE CITY** has not taken any steps or made any efforts to halt this course of conduct, to make redress to the plaintiff or other citizens injured thereby, or to take any disciplinary action whatever against any of their employees or agents.

49. The unlawful and illegal conduct of the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees and each of them, deprived plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ** of the following rights, privileges and immunities secured to him by the Constitution of the United States and of the State of New York: The right of plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, to be secure in his person and effects against unreasonable search and seizure under the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States; the right of plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, to be informed of the nature and cause of the accusation against him as secured to him under the Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States; and the right of plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, not to be deprived of life, liberty or property without due process of law, and the right to the equal protection of the laws secured by the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

50. That the deprivation of plaintiff's Constitutional rights was the result of the unconstitutional acts of defendants while acting under color of state law and within the scope of their employ.

51. That the deprivation of plaintiff's Constitutional rights was the result of the defendant, **THE CITY's** custom and/or policy of arresting individuals without probable cause.

52. That the deprivation of plaintiff's Constitutional rights was the result of the defendant, **THE CITY's** custom and/or policy of arresting minorities without probable cause.

53. That the deprivation of plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ's**, Constitutional Rights was the result of the defendant, **THE CITY's**, custom and/or policy of failing to discipline officers for arresting individuals without probable cause.

54. That the said customs and/or policies may be inferred from the existence of other similar Civil Rights actions that have been brought against the defendant, **THE CITY**.

55. That the detaining of plaintiff, **ABDELALIM ABDELBAKY**, without probable cause or justification was the result of customs and/or policies adopted by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

56. That the deprivation of plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ's** Constitutional rights was the result of the defendant, **GRANT's** false detainment of the plaintiff **HOPETON SUAREZ** without probable cause.

57. That the deprivation of plaintiff **HOPETON SUAREZ's**

Constitutional Rights was a result of the defendant, **THE CITY'S** custom and policy in failing to discipline officers for the use of excessive force.

58. That the deprivation of plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ's** Constitutional rights was the result of the defendant, **GRANT's** use of excessive force.

59. That the customs and/or policies adopted by the defendant, **THE CITY** exhibited a deliberate indifference to the Constitutional rights of plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**.

60. That by reason of the allegations as set forth in all of the aforementioned causes of actions, including, but not limited to the plaintiff's false detainment/imprisonment, assault and battery, as well as prosecution due to the negligence of the defendant and/or defendants, in the negligent hiring, negligent retention, and negligent training of its various employees and/or police officers, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was caused to have his civil rights as guaranteed under the U.S. Constitution, including, but not limited to the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments, violated by the defendant and/or defendants herein, as set forth under 42 U.S.C. Section 1983.

61. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff **HOPETON SUAREZ**, was injured; was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled; was and/or will be caused to undergo medical treatment and advice; was unable to pursue her usual and regular activities;

and upon information and belief, her injuries are permanent in nature and effect.

62. That this action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving the defendant and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

63. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ**, has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

WHEREFORE, plaintiff, **HOPETON SUAREZ** , demands judgment against the defendants, on the First, Second, Third, and Fourth causes of actions in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all of the lower Courts of the State of New York; together with interest, as well as the costs, disbursements and legal fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. Section 1988, of these causes of action.

Dated: New York, New York
December 10, 2018

Yours, etc.

SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C.
Attorneys for Plaintiff,
HOPETON SUAREZ
Office & P.O. Address
30 Vesey Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007
(212) 227-8865

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

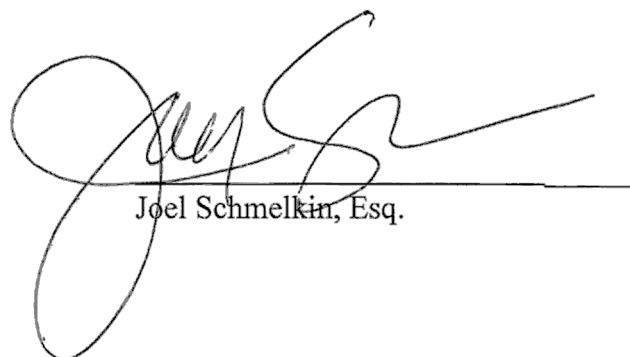
STATE OF NEW YORK)
) ss.:
COUNTY OF NEW YORK)

Joel Schmelkin, an attorney admitted to practice law in the State of New York, states, the following:

I am a member of the law firm of Schmelkin Associates, P.C., the attorneys of record for the plaintiff in the within action. I have read the foregoing **COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief and that as to those matters, I believe it to be true. This verification is made by me and not by the plaintiff because the plaintiff does not reside in the County where Schmelkin Associates, P.C. maintains its office.

The grounds of my belief as to all matters not stated upon my knowledge are conversations with plaintiff and contents of the file maintained by Schmelkin Associates, P.C.

Dated: New York, New York
 December 10, 2018



Joel Schmelkin, Esq.

Index No.

Year 20

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

HOPETON SUAREZ,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK and JAMES M. GRANT,

Defendants.

SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C.

Attorneys for Plaintiff(s)

Hopeton Suarez

Office and Post Office Address, Telephone

30 VESEY STREET, 4TH FLOOR

NEW YORK, N.Y. 10007

TEL: (212) 227-8865

Pursuant to 22 NYCRR 130-1.1-a, the undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, certifies that, upon information and belief and reasonable inquiry, (1) the contentions contained in the annexed document are not frivolous and that (2) if the annexed document is an initiating pleading, (i) the matter was not obtained through illegal conduct, or that if it was, the attorney or other persons responsible for the illegal conduct are not participating in the matter or sharing in any fee earned therefrom and that (ii) if the matter involves potential claims for personal injury or wrongful death, the matter was not obtained in violation of 22 NYCRR 1200.41-a.

Dated: December 10, 2018

Signature

Print Signer's Name: JOEL SCHMELKIN

Service of a copy of the within

is hereby admitted.

Dated:

Attorney(s) for

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE

Check Applicable Box

NOTICE OF
ENTRYthat the within is a (certified) true copy of a
entered in the office of the clerk of the within-named Court on

20

NOTICE OF
SETTLEMENTthat an Order of which the within is a true copy will be presented for settlement to the
Hon. , one of the judges of the within-named Court,
at
on 20 , at M.

Dated:

SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C.

Attorneys for Plaintiff(s)

To:

Office and Post Office Address, Telephone
30 VESEY STREET, 4TH FLOOR